

IEP Advocacy Letter Templates

6 Fill-in-the-Blank Letters Every Special Education Parent Needs

Knowledge is power. Partnership is progress. Together — the IEP gets APPROVED.

How to Use These Templates

These letters are legally grounded templates that you can customize for your specific situation. Replace all text in [BRACKETS] with your information. Send all letters via email AND certified mail with return receipt so you have proof of delivery. Keep copies of everything.

Pro Tip: IEP Pro members can ask Ada to generate a personalized version of any letter based on their specific situation at iepapproved.com/ada

LETTER 1: Request for Initial Special Education Evaluation

When to Use: Use this when you suspect your child has a disability and want the school to evaluate them.

Legal Basis: IDEA 34 CFR § 300.301 — Schools must respond within 60 days of receiving your written request (or your state's timeline).

[DATE]

[YOUR NAME]

[YOUR ADDRESS]

[CITY, STATE, ZIP]

[YOUR EMAIL]

[YOUR PHONE]

[PRINCIPAL'S NAME], Principal

[SCHOOL NAME]

[SCHOOL ADDRESS]

[CITY, STATE, ZIP]

RE: Written Request for Full and Individual Initial Evaluation

Student: [CHILD'S FULL NAME] | DOB: [DATE OF BIRTH] | Grade: [GRADE]

Dear [PRINCIPAL'S NAME],

I am writing to formally request a full and individual initial evaluation of my child, [CHILD'S NAME], pursuant to the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act (IDEA), 20 U.S.C. § 1414, and its implementing regulations at 34 CFR § 300.301.

I have concerns about the following areas of my child's development and educational performance:

[DESCRIBE YOUR CONCERNS IN DETAIL — e.g., reading difficulties, attention challenges, speech delays, behavioral concerns, academic struggles]

I am requesting that the evaluation include, but not be limited to, assessments in the following areas: [LIST AREAS — e.g., academic achievement, cognitive ability, speech and language, social-emotional functioning, occupational therapy, physical therapy]

Please provide me with your written response, including the proposed evaluation plan and your Prior Written Notice, within the timeframe required by law. I am available to discuss this request and provide consent for evaluation at your earliest convenience.

I understand that I will receive a copy of my Procedural Safeguards upon your receipt of this request.

Sincerely,

[YOUR SIGNATURE]

[YOUR PRINTED NAME]

Parent/Guardian of [CHILD'S NAME]

cc: [SPECIAL EDUCATION DIRECTOR'S NAME], Director of Special Education

[CHILD'S TEACHER'S NAME]

[YOUR FILE]

LETTER 2: Request for Independent Educational Evaluation (IEE)

When to Use: Use this when you disagree with the school's evaluation and want an independent evaluation at public expense.

Legal Basis: IDEA 34 CFR § 300.502 — Parents have the right to obtain an IEE at public expense if they disagree with the school's evaluation.

[DATE]

[YOUR NAME]

[YOUR ADDRESS]

[CITY, STATE, ZIP]

[SPECIAL EDUCATION DIRECTOR'S NAME]

Director of Special Education

[SCHOOL DISTRICT NAME]

[ADDRESS]

RE: Request for Independent Educational Evaluation at Public Expense

Student: [CHILD'S FULL NAME] | DOB: [DATE OF BIRTH]

Dear [DIRECTOR'S NAME],

Pursuant to the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act (IDEA), 34 CFR § 300.502, I am formally requesting an Independent Educational Evaluation (IEE) of my child, [CHILD'S NAME], at public expense.

I disagree with the results of the evaluation conducted by [SCHOOL DISTRICT NAME] on [DATE OF SCHOOL'S EVALUATION] in the area(s) of: [SPECIFY AREAS YOU DISAGREE WITH].

My specific concerns with the district's evaluation include: [DESCRIBE YOUR CONCERNS — e.g., the evaluator did not observe my child in the classroom, the assessment tools were not appropriate, the results do not reflect my child's actual abilities]

Under 34 CFR § 300.502(b), the district must either: (1) provide the IEE at public expense, or (2) initiate a due process hearing to show that its evaluation was appropriate.

Please provide me with a written response within [10] business days that includes the district's criteria for IEEs, including evaluator qualifications and the geographic area in which evaluators must be located.

Sincerely,

[YOUR SIGNATURE]

[YOUR PRINTED NAME]

Parent/Guardian of [CHILD'S NAME]

LETTER 3: Dispute Proposed Placement Change

When to Use: Use this when the school proposes changing your child's placement and you disagree.

Legal Basis: IDEA 34 CFR § 300.503 — Schools must provide Prior Written Notice before changing placement. You have the right to refuse consent.

[DATE]

[YOUR NAME]

[YOUR ADDRESS]

[CITY, STATE, ZIP]

[SPECIAL EDUCATION DIRECTOR'S NAME]

Director of Special Education

[SCHOOL DISTRICT NAME]

[ADDRESS]

RE: Written Objection to Proposed Placement Change

Student: [CHILD'S FULL NAME] | DOB: [DATE OF BIRTH]

Dear [DIRECTOR'S NAME],

I am writing in response to the Prior Written Notice dated [DATE OF PWN] proposing to change my child [CHILD'S NAME]'s educational placement from [CURRENT PLACEMENT] to [PROPOSED PLACEMENT].

I do not consent to this proposed change for the following reasons:

1. [REASON ONE — e.g., The proposed placement does not represent the Least Restrictive Environment as required by 34 CFR § 300.114]
2. [REASON TWO — e.g., The data presented at the IEP meeting does not support the need for a more restrictive placement]
3. [REASON THREE — e.g., Appropriate supports and services have not been provided in the current placement to determine whether it can be made to work]

Under IDEA, any change in educational placement requires my written consent. I am hereby withholding consent for this proposed change pending further discussion and review.

I request a meeting within [10] business days to discuss this matter further. I also request all data and documentation that supports the district's recommendation.

During the pendency of this dispute, my child's current educational placement must be maintained pursuant to the "stay put" provision at 20 U.S.C. § 1415(j).

Sincerely,

[YOUR SIGNATURE]

[YOUR PRINTED NAME]

Parent/Guardian of [CHILD'S NAME]

LETTER 4: Transportation Accommodation Request

When to Use: Use this when the school is not providing required transportation services.

Legal Basis: IDEA 34 CFR § 300.34(c)(16) — Transportation is a related service that must be provided when required for a child to access FAPE.

[DATE]

[YOUR NAME]

[YOUR ADDRESS]

[CITY, STATE, ZIP]

[PRINCIPAL'S NAME], Principal

[SCHOOL NAME]

[ADDRESS]

RE: Request for Transportation as a Related Service

Student: [CHILD'S FULL NAME] | DOB: [DATE OF BIRTH]

Dear [PRINCIPAL'S NAME],

I am writing to formally request that transportation be included as a related service in my child [CHILD'S NAME]'s Individualized Education Program.

Under the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act, transportation is defined as a related service at 34 CFR § 300.34(c)(16), which includes: travel to and from school and between schools, travel in and around school buildings, and specialized equipment as may be required.

My child requires transportation because: [EXPLAIN WHY TRANSPORTATION IS NECESSARY — e.g., the distance to school, the child's disability prevents independent travel, specialized equipment is needed, the assigned program is not the neighborhood school]

I request that this be discussed and resolved at the earliest possible IEP meeting. Please provide Prior Written Notice of the district's response to this request.

I understand that if transportation is required for my child to receive FAPE, it must be provided at no cost to our family.

Sincerely,

[YOUR SIGNATURE]

[YOUR PRINTED NAME]

Parent/Guardian of [CHILD'S NAME]

LETTER 5: Request for IEP Meeting

When to Use: Use this to formally request an IEP meeting at any time.

Legal Basis: IDEA 34 CFR § 300.321 — Parents are members of the IEP team and may request meetings. Schools must respond to reasonable requests.

[DATE]

[YOUR NAME]

[YOUR ADDRESS]

[CITY, STATE, ZIP]

[SPECIAL EDUCATION CONTACT NAME]

[SCHOOL NAME]

[ADDRESS]

RE: Formal Request for IEP Team Meeting

Student: [CHILD'S FULL NAME] | DOB: [DATE OF BIRTH]

Dear [CONTACT NAME],

Pursuant to IDEA and my rights as a parent member of my child's IEP team under 34 CFR § 300.321, I am formally requesting an IEP team meeting to discuss the following concerns:

[LIST YOUR SPECIFIC CONCERNS — e.g.:

- My child is not making adequate progress on current IEP goals
- I believe additional services are needed
- I have concerns about implementation of the current IEP
- My child's needs have changed significantly]

I request that the following individuals attend this meeting:

[LIST REQUIRED OR REQUESTED ATTENDEES]

I am available on the following dates and times: [LIST YOUR AVAILABILITY]

Please confirm the meeting date and time in writing. I understand that the school must make reasonable efforts to schedule this meeting at a mutually convenient time.

Sincerely,

[YOUR SIGNATURE]

[YOUR PRINTED NAME]

Parent/Guardian of [CHILD'S NAME]

LETTER 6: Formal Complaint — State Education Agency

When to Use: Use this when the school district has violated IDEA and you want to file a formal complaint with your State Education Agency.

Legal Basis: IDEA 34 CFR § 300.151-153 — The State Education Agency must investigate and resolve complaints within 60 days.

[DATE]

[YOUR NAME]

[YOUR ADDRESS]

[CITY, STATE, ZIP]

[YOUR EMAIL]

[YOUR PHONE]

State Director of Special Education

[YOUR STATE] Department of Education

[STATE EDUCATION AGENCY ADDRESS]

RE: State Complaint — Alleged Violation of IDEA

Student: [CHILD'S FULL NAME] | DOB: [DATE OF BIRTH]

School District: [SCHOOL DISTRICT NAME]

School: [SCHOOL NAME]

Dear State Director,

Pursuant to 34 CFR §§ 300.151-300.153, I am filing a formal complaint against [SCHOOL DISTRICT NAME] for the following alleged violation(s) of the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act (IDEA):

ALLEGED VIOLATION(S):

[DESCRIBE EACH VIOLATION CLEARLY AND SPECIFICALLY — e.g.:

1. The district failed to provide [SPECIFIC SERVICE] as required by my child's IEP
2. The district changed my child's placement without providing Prior Written Notice
3. The district failed to conduct a timely evaluation]

FACTS SUPPORTING THIS COMPLAINT:

[PROVIDE SPECIFIC DATES, EVENTS, AND DOCUMENTATION — e.g.:

- On [DATE], I requested [ACTION] in writing
- On [DATE], the school responded by [RESPONSE]
- Despite my request, the district has failed to [ACTION] as of the date of this complaint]

PROPOSED RESOLUTION:

[STATE WHAT YOU ARE ASKING FOR — e.g., that the district provide compensatory services, that the district implement the IEP as written, that the district conduct the overdue evaluation]

I am attaching the following documents in support of this complaint:

[LIST YOUR ATTACHMENTS]

I request that the State Education Agency investigate this complaint and issue a written findings report within the required 60-day timeline.

Sincerely,

[YOUR SIGNATURE]

[YOUR PRINTED NAME]

Parent/Guardian of [CHILD'S NAME]

Attachments: [LIST]

cc: [SCHOOL DISTRICT SUPERINTENDENT]

[YOUR FILE]